

Digital Platforms and E-Governance — Detailed Lecture Notes

JKSSB Computer Awareness

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57.1 What e-Governance means

A running government delivers many services: certificates, licences, payments, benefits, and information. **e-Governance** is the use of Information and Communication Technology (ICT) by government to deliver these services. Instead of standing at a physical counter, a citizen reaches the service through an online portal. The aim is to make services accessible, efficient, transparent, and reliable.

e-Governance is about governance, not merely about technology. The technology is the tool; the purpose is better delivery of public services.

Definition (e-Governance). *The use of Information and Communication Technology (ICT) by government to deliver services to citizens, businesses, and other parts of government in an accessible, efficient, transparent, and reliable way.*

Term	Meaning in this lesson
e-Governance	ICT-based delivery of government services.
G2x	The interaction categories: G2C, G2G, G2B, G2E.
Digital India	The flagship Government of India programme launched on 1 July 2015.
NeGP	National e-Governance Plan, approved in May 2006.
e-Kranti	Pillar 5 of Digital India and the upgraded NeGP (NeGP 2.0).
NeGD	National e-Governance Division, created in 2009 under MeitY.
e-NAM	National Agriculture Market, the pan-India agricultural trading portal.

57.2 The G2x classification

e-Governance interactions are named by who takes part. The “G” always stands for Government, and the letter after it says who the government is interacting with.

Type	Full form	Who is served / examples
G2C	Government to Citizen	The general public. UMANG, DigiLocker, certificates, utility bills.
G2G	Government to Government	Government departments and levels. e-Office, PFMS.
G2B	Government to Business	Businesses and companies. GeM, GSTN.
G2E	Government to Employee	Government employees. An employee service book or salary portal.

The classification is the highest-yield part of this topic. An item can name a platform and ask which G2x category it belongs to, or name a category and ask which platform fits. The safe method is to ask “who is the government serving?” A citizen means G2C; another government body means G2G; a company means G2B; an employee means G2E.

Example 57.2.1. *The stem asks, “GeM (Government e-Marketplace) is an example of which category?” GeM is used by government to buy goods and services from businesses, so the government is serving a business. The answer is G2B, not G2C. A student who sees only that “government uses it” may wrongly choose G2C; the deciding question is who is on the other side.*

57.3 Digital India

Digital India is a flagship programme of the Government of India. It was launched on **1 July 2015** by the Prime Minister, with the vision to transform India into a **digitally empowered society and knowledge economy**.

The programme rests on **three vision areas**:

- (i) Digital Infrastructure as a Core Utility to Every Citizen;
- (ii) Governance and Services on Demand;
- (iii) Digital Empowerment of Citizens.

Under these vision areas the programme is built on **nine pillars**: Broadband Highways; Universal Access to Mobile Connectivity; Public Internet Access Programme; e-Governance: Reforming Government through Technology; e-Kranti: Electronic Delivery of Services; Information for All; Electronics Manufacturing; IT for Jobs; and Early Harvest Programmes. Pillar 5, e-Kranti, is the service-delivery pillar and is treated separately below.

Definition (Digital India). *A flagship Government of India programme, launched on 1 July 2015, with the vision of transforming India into a digitally empowered society and knowledge economy, built on three vision areas and nine pillars.*

57.4 NeGP, e-Kranti, and NeGD: three names, three things

These three names are close and are a standing source of confusion. They are kept apart here by asking what each one *is*.

The **National e-Governance Plan (NeGP)** is the older umbrella *plan*. It was approved in **May 2006**, with the vision to make all government services accessible to the common man in his locality, through common service delivery outlets, at affordable cost. It is built around **Mission Mode Projects (MMPs)** — 27 MMPs with supporting components.

e-Kranti means “electronic delivery of services”. It is **Pillar 5** of the Digital India programme and is also called **NeGP 2.0**, an upgraded approach to the National e-Governance Plan. Its vision is “Transforming e-Governance for Transforming Governance”, and its mission is to deliver all government services electronically through integrated and interoperable systems.

The **National e-Governance Division (NeGD)** is not a plan at all. It is an *organisation*. It was created in **2009** by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) as an independent business division under the Digital India Corporation. Its role is to support MeitY in the programme management and implementation of e-Governance projects, and to give technical and advisory support to ministries and departments.

Name	What it is	Year	One word
NeGP	Umbrella e-Governance plan with 27 MMPs	2006	The plan
e-Kranti	Pillar 5 of Digital India; NeGP 2.0	2015	The approach
NeGD	Division under MeitY supporting projects	2009	The body

Example 57.4.1. *An item states, “NeGD is the National e-Governance Plan approved in 2006.” This is wrong on two counts. The plan approved in 2006 is **NeGP** (National e-Governance Plan). **NeGD** is the National e-Governance Division, an organisation created in 2009. The distractor swaps a plan for a body.*

57.5 e-NAM and agricultural marketing

e-NAM stands for **National Agriculture Market** (also written eNAM). It is a pan-India **electronic trading portal** for agricultural commodities, launched on **14 April 2016**. It is implemented by the **Small Farmers Agribusiness Consortium (SFAC)** under the Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare. The portal is available at **enam.gov.in**.

The key idea is that e-NAM **networks the existing Agriculture Produce Market Committee (APMC) mandis** to create a **unified national market** for agricultural commodities. Because trade happens online, farmers get **online competitive bidding and transparent price discovery**, and direct sale to buyers reduces the role of intermediaries.

Definition (e-NAM). *The National Agriculture Market, a pan-India electronic trading portal, launched on 14 April 2016, that networks the existing APMC mandis to create a unified national market for agricultural commodities.*

A near-neighbour to keep separate is **AGMARKNET**. AGMARKNET is a portal that provides agricultural marketing *information* such as market prices. e-NAM, by contrast, is the *trading* platform where the sale itself takes place. An item that asks for the agricultural marketing *trading* platform wants e-NAM.

57.6 Citizen portal, electronic records, and authentication

The **National Portal of India** is **india.gov.in**. It is a **single-window** gateway from which a citizen can reach the information and services of the Government of India. A related platform, **MyGov**, is the citizen-engagement platform for participative governance.

Electronic governance depends on giving electronic documents the same standing as paper. The **Information Technology Act, 2000** gives legal recognition to **electronic records**. An electronic record can be stored, retrieved, and used in electronic form. To be trustworthy, it must be authenticated.

Authentication proves that a message or document is genuine and comes from the claimed sender. A **digital signature** provides authenticity, integrity, and non-repudiation. **Encryption**, by contrast, provides confidentiality: it keeps the content secret from unauthorised readers. **Aadhaar** is used as a digital identity for authentication of a person.

Definition (Digital signature). *A mechanism used to authenticate an electronic record. It provides authenticity, integrity, and non-repudiation, and is distinct from encryption, which provides confidentiality.*

Example 57.6.1. *An item states, “A digital signature encrypts the document so that only the recipient can read it.” This confuses two ideas. Encrypting for secrecy is **encryption**, which provides confidentiality. A **digital signature** proves who sent the document and that it was not altered; it provides authenticity and integrity. The wrong option has used the signature’s name for encryption’s job.*

57.7 Exam retrieval and common confusions

Six distinctions prevent most errors on this topic.

1. e-NAM = agricultural marketing and trading; it is **not** general e-commerce.
2. GeM = G2B procurement, **not** a G2C service. e-Office and PFMS are G2G.
3. NeGP (plan, 2006), e-Kranti (pillar / NeGP 2.0, 2015), and NeGD (division, 2009) are three different things; do not swap them.
4. Digital signature = authenticity and integrity; encryption = confidentiality. They are **not** the same (TRAP-15).
5. The citizen portal of the Government of India is india.gov.in, not the Digital India or NeGD site.
6. Digital India is built on three vision areas and nine pillars; e-Kranti is Pillar 5, the service-delivery pillar.

Example 57.7.1. *An item asks which body supports MeitY in the programme management of e-Governance projects. Trace the three names: NeGP is a plan, e-Kranti is a pillar, and only NeGD is an organisation. The answer is NeGD.*

Exercises

1. Expand e-NAM and state its purpose in one line.
2. Distinguish G2C, G2G, G2B, and G2E, giving one example of each.
3. State the launch date and vision of the Digital India programme.
4. Explain the difference between NeGP, e-Kranti, and NeGD.
5. Define authentication and explain how a digital signature differs from encryption.

Solutions

1. e-NAM is the National Agriculture Market: a pan-India electronic trading portal that networks the existing APMC mandis to create a unified national market for agricultural commodities.
2. G2C (Government to Citizen) serves the public, e.g. UMANG; G2G (Government to Government) serves government bodies, e.g. e-Office; G2B (Government to Business) serves businesses, e.g. GeM; G2E (Government to Employee) serves government employees, e.g. an employee service book.
3. Digital India was launched on 1 July 2015, with the vision to transform India into a digitally empowered society and knowledge economy.

4. NeGP is the National e-Governance Plan, the umbrella plan approved in May 2006 with 27 MMPs. e-Kranti is Pillar 5 of Digital India and the upgraded NeGP (NeGP 2.0). NeGD is the National e-Governance Division, an organisation created in 2009 under MeitY to support e-Governance projects.
5. Authentication proves that a message or document is genuine and comes from the claimed sender. A digital signature provides authenticity, integrity, and non-repudiation; encryption provides confidentiality by keeping the content secret. They are different functions.